

KING COUNTY PLAY EQUITY COALITION · 2027

Every kid deserves a place to play.

The King County Play Equity Report

Research by the University of Washington Center for Leadership in Athletics
Guided by the Community Advisory Board

PRINT EDITION · SAMPLE EDITION FOR DESIGN REVIEW · SAMPLE DATA WHERE MARKED

CONTENTS

Inside this report

00 Where we started 3

01 Who's playing — and who isn't 4

02 What gets in the way 5

03 Places to play 6

04 Youth voice 7

05 What we do next 8

— How we did this 9

How to use this print edition

- Each chart has a **QR code**. Scan it with your phone to open the live, filterable version.
- Prefer a screen? The **interactive PDF** and **full website** live at the address below.

Read online, explore the data, watch the videos: **kc-play-equity-report.pplx.app**

WHERE WE STARTED

In 2019, King County earned a D for getting kids active.

The first *State of Play Seattle–King County* surveyed and interviewed more than 1,600 local adults and young people. It found that barely one in five youth got the recommended hour of daily activity — and that girls, youth of color, youth with disabilities and youth who don't speak English at home were less active still. This report asks what has changed.

19%

of King County youth met the CDC's 60-minutes-a-day activity guideline

D

grade given to Seattle–King County for getting youth active

13%

of youth never joined organized sport because of cost

~3×

more likely to have never played if English isn't spoken at home

2019 baseline, published. Sources: Aspen Institute, *State of Play Seattle–King County* (aspeninstitute.org); Seattle Parks Foundation; Seattle Parks & Recreation Strategic Plan (2020).

> **"Instead of paying $1,500 to $2,000 for one season, I can buy a $300–$400 Xbox and a PlayStation, and my kid will be at home safe."**
>
> Parent, State of Play focus group · published by KCPEC

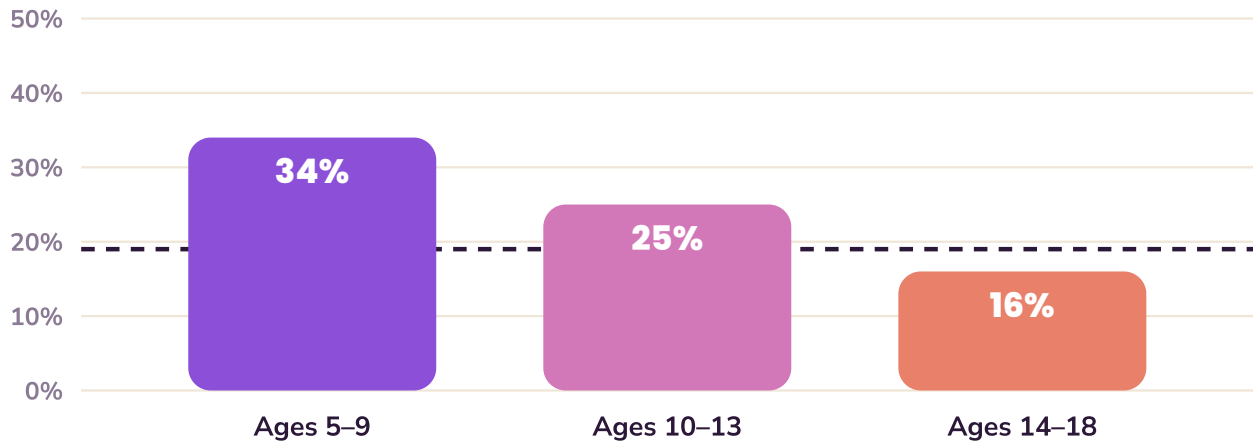
CHAPTER 01

Who's playing — and who isn't

Activity drops sharply as kids get older. The steepest fall comes between middle school and high school — exactly when sport costs and travel demands rise.

Youth meeting 60 minutes of activity a day, by age · dashed line = 2019 baseline (19%)

SAMPLE DATA



Explore this data by gender, income, region & language
Scan to open the live, filterable version
kc-play-equity-report.pplx.app/#/explore?tab=activity

Top 5 sports youth played in the past year

SAMPLE DATA



See the top 10 sports & filter by group
Scan to open the live, filterable version
kc-play-equity-report.pplx.app/#/explore?tab=sports

CHAPTER 02

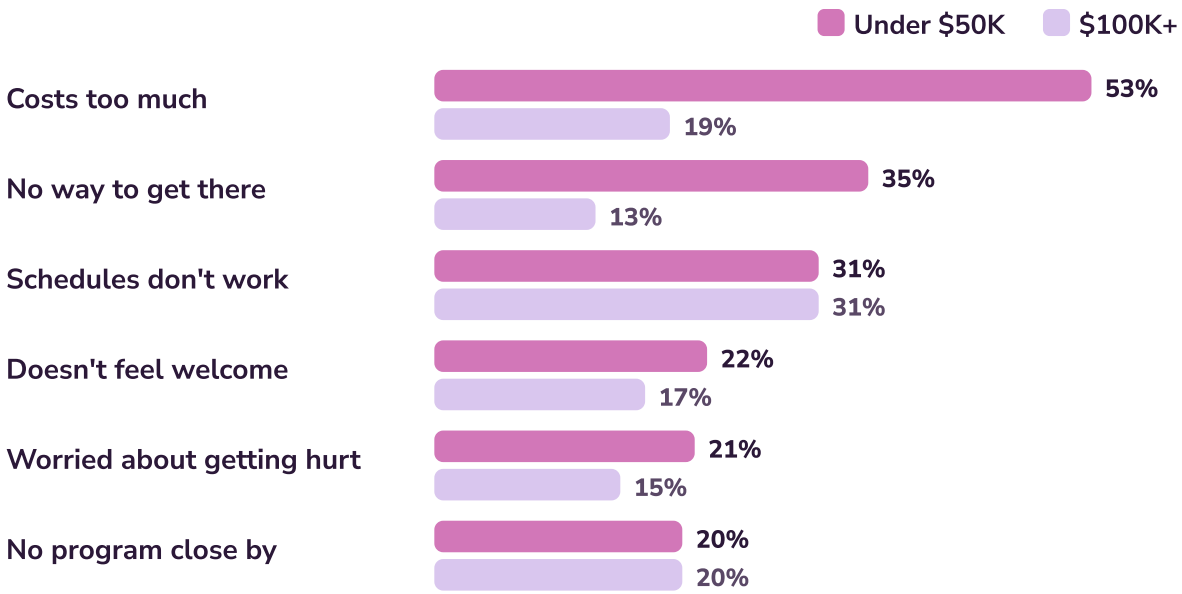
What gets in the way



Families named the same barriers again and again: cost, getting there, schedules that don't fit working parents, and not feeling like a program was meant for them.

Top reasons youth don't play, by household income

SAMPLE DATA



Explore barriers for every group

Scan to open the live, filterable version

kc-play-equity-report.pplx.app/#/explore?tab=barriers

CHAPTER 03

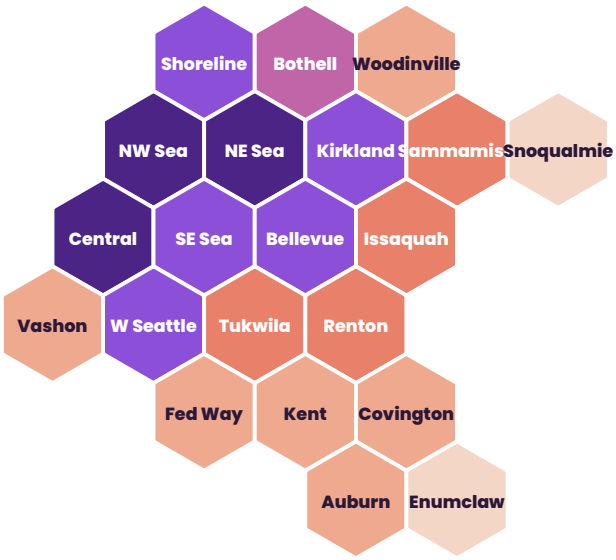
Places to play



King County has world-class outdoor space, but it isn't evenly shared. Fields are booked by travel teams, and South King County and rural areas have fewer low-cost programs per child.

Youth within a 10-minute walk of a park or field

SAMPLE DATA



46%

Des Moines / Federal Way

Youth within a 10-minute walk of a park — county average 59%.

95%

Central & Downtown Seattle

Highest access in the county.

Open the interactive access map

Scan to open the live, filterable version

kc-play-equity-report.pplx.app/#/explore?tab=places

CHAPTER 04

Youth voice



Young people told us the best part of sport is having fun with friends. Through Youth Action Mapping, they also showed us — block by block — what helps and what gets in the way.

> **“We mapped every court within a mile of school. Half had no nets.”**
>
> Youth Action Mapping team member · sample quote

Open the Youth Action Map
Scan to open the live, filterable version
kc-play-equity-report.pplx.app/#/youth-mapping

Community Advisory Board, in their own voices







Watch the Advisory Board videos
Scan to open the live, filterable version
kc-play-equity-report.pplx.app/#/advisory-board

CHAPTER 05

What we do next

Each recommendation names who can act, so every reader can find the part that belongs to them.

01

Make the first season free

FUNDERS · PARKS

02

Open the gates for free play

PARKS · SCHOOLS

03

Get kids there

TRANSIT · SCHOOLS

04

Train every coach for belonging

COACHES · FUNDERS

05

Speak families' languages

PARKS · COMMUNITY ORGS

06

Keep listening to youth

COALITION · YOUTH

> **"Coaches are the front door to sport. Train us and the door stays open."**
>
> Youth coach, stakeholder interview · sample quote

Sample recommendations shown to demonstrate layout. Final recommendations come from the Coalition and UW research team.

Read the full recommendations online
Scan to open the live, filterable version
kc-play-equity-report.pplx.app/#/report/action

HOW WE DID THIS

Four ways of listening.

Parents

Statewide parent survey, King County sample

35

Stakeholder interviews

Groups

Community focus groups

Youth

Youth survey & Youth Action Mapping

Protecting the people who shared their stories

- Only aggregated, de-identified results are published.
- Any result based on fewer than 10 people is suppressed.
- Quotes, photos and videos appear only with documented consent.

KEEP EXPLORING

Filter the data. Watch the videos. Read the youth map.

Visit the full report online

kc-play-equity-report.pplx.app

Concept edition prepared by The Data Guys for the Play Equity Report design subcommittee. Sample data is illustrative only and will be replaced with final UW analysis.